

2 Poisson & binomial distributions	2.1	The Poisson distribution	Students will be expected to use this distribution to model a real-world situation and to comment critically on the appropriateness. Students will be expected to use their calculators to calculate probabilities including cumulative probabilities. Students will be expected to use the additive property of the Poisson distribution. E.g. if $X = \text{the number of events per minute}$ and $X \sim \text{Po}(\lambda)$, then the number of events per 5 minutes $\sim \text{Po}(5\lambda)$.
		The additive property of Poisson distributions	If X and Y are independent random variables with $X \sim \text{Po}(\lambda)$ and $Y \sim \text{Po}(\mu)$, then $X + Y \sim \text{Po}(\lambda + \mu)$ No proofs are required.
	2.2	The mean and variance of the binomial distribution and the Poisson distribution.	Knowledge and use of : If $X \sim B(n, p)$, then $E(X) = np$ and $\text{Var}(X) = np(1 - p)$ If $Y \sim \text{Po}(\lambda)$, then $E(Y) = \lambda$ and $\text{Var}(Y) = \lambda$ Derivations are not required.
	2.3	The use of the Poisson distribution as an approximation to the binomial distribution.	When n is large and p is small the distribution $B(n, p)$ can be approximated by $\text{Po}(np)$. Derivations are not required.